tinder

PRODUCT MANAGEMENT CASE STUDY

Tinder DATE

An AI-Powered Date Planning Feature

Solving “Where to Meet”, “Where to Eat” and “What to Do” to turn more matches into real-life dates

Prepared by	Gourvi Sharma
Program	PGDM – Big Data Analytics
Date	2nd August 2026
Tools / Method used	User research (primary & secondary), persona mapping, RICE prioritization, high-level system design and a success-metrics framework (North Star, NPS, CSAT)
Purpose	To design an AI-driven feature that helps matched Tinder users decide where to meet, where to eat and what to do on a date.

Swipe-based online dating app

What?

Why?

Tinder: “Swipe right”

GENDER RATIO
3M:1F

MARKETSHARE (US)
27%

tinder

MAU
75M

Users <35 yrs old
65%

Create profile → Set Preferences → Swipe to indicate like → Match → Chat

Source

OBJECTIVE: As a PM on the Growth team of **Tinder** address the problems of **‘where to meet’, ‘where to eat’ and ‘what to do’.**

Why Tinder?

1. Tinder is the **Leading global dating app** with extensive user data for **behavior** and **trend analysis**.
2. Tinder **pioneered** the **swipe interface**, making it an interesting case study. Moreover, Tinder continuously innovates with features like **Super Likes** and **Swipe Surge.**
3. Has largely **Influenced dating norms and social interactions,** shaping modern relationships!

Competitors

happn

Grindr

okcupid

bumble

clover

match.

CoffeeMeetsBagel

Understanding the Online Dating Landscape

Vidit Jain (21yrs)
Student @ Bits Goa

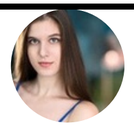
- **Dating** is about getting to know **someone special**.
- Often people join dating apps **hoping to find balance**, but they quickly realize that the **quality of matches isn't what they expected**, so they leave.



Avi Chauhan
(28yrs), Business Analyst, Zomato

"I have faced majorly two problems, it's incredibly hard to **find places to go to** and **things to do for dates**. This problem increases more with the more number of dates you go to."

Ayushi Gupta
(23yrs), C.A.



I'm a foodie, and I love exploring new places, the issue is that its a **hassle to find places to eat** that my partner wants to visit as well. It becomes a task before going on dates

User needs *VS* **Pain Points**

- **Need** to go on dates with potential partners **but** often waste time being indecisive about where to meet.
- **Need** to choose a place to eat **but** end up spending too much time debating options.
- **Need** to decide on fun date activities **but** often struggle to agree on something both will enjoy

A closer look into the why users are choosing Tinder

Tinder's **large user base** and **easy swipe feature** attract users. Innovative features like Super Likes boost engagement. It simplifies meeting new people.

What does the perfect date look like for the user?

The perfect date is **well-planned** and **unique**, offering a **personalized experience**. It involves **engaging activities** and **dining without planning stress**

How are the users solving these problems currently?

Users spend time **messaging** to decide plans and use multiple apps for ideas. This often results in **conventional, uninspired dates.**

Secondary Research

Data Analysis on Github

Users: **1000+**
4M:1F
Median Age: **24**

ONLY 16% HAVE MET A PARTNER THROUGH DATING APPS ~55% OF THE CONVERSATIONS DON'T END UP WITH A DATE

ONLY 68% OF RESPONDENTS ALIGN DATING APPS WITH LONG-TERM DATING

USERS PURSUE THEIR MATCH FOR 2 DAYS ON AVERAGE

MALES ARE 8 TIMES MORE LIKELY TO SWIPE RIGHT A PROFILE FEMALES ARE 18 TIMES MORE LIKELY TO GHOST A MATCH

Key takeaways from secondary research

Around 30% of users eventually ghost their match, possibly because of unfruitful dating experience .
Source

In general, people are finding it hard to meet possible partners in real life.
Source

What is causing the issue?

Users want to go on **dates** with each other

They can't decide on **where to meet**

- Minimal and selective self-information.
- Limited knowledge of mutual interests.
- Hard to find a convenient location.

They can't decide on **where to eat**

- Hard to agree on cuisine.
- Different dietary preferences.
- Unfamiliar with local options.

They can't decide on **what to do**

- Can't decide on activities.
- Limited knowledge of local options.
- Uncomfortable with new experiences

How do we know this is a real problem?

34% RESPONDENTS FIND IT DIFFICULT TO START A CONVERSATION

AROUND 50% OF USERS NEVER ACTUALLY GO ON DATES

30% OF CONVERSATIONS END WITH JUST ONE MESSAGE EXCHANGED

USERS SWIPE 111 TIMES/DAY ON AN AVERAGE

THERE'S ABOUT A 25% INCREASE IN THE NUMBER OF TIMES THE APP IS OPENED DURING THE HOLIDAY SEASON

Problems and their Solutions

WHERE TO MEET

1: Smart Meeting Point Suggestions - Using AI and tracking history data for both partners, **recommend meeting points** close to both of their locations. This can come within the chat from an automated bot that can ask for poll for suggestions from time-to-time.
2. Favorite Spots List: While creating the profiles, allow users to **create lists of their favorite or frequently visited spots**, which can be used as quick suggestions for future dates.

WHERE TO EAT

1: Dynamic Restaurant Finder: A recommendation algorithm that suggests restaurants based on user profiles, including cuisine preferences, dietary restrictions, and prior dining history
2. Local Cuisine Explorer: A feature that **highlights trending and highly rated local restaurants,** including user-generated content like reviews and photos.

WHAT TO DO

1: Activity Matchmaker: A tool that pairs users with activities based on shared interests. Offer a variety of categories such as outdoor activities, cultural events, and workshops.
2. Curated Experience Package: Offer curated date packages that include a combination of activities, dining, and entertainment. Around interests, such as adventure, relaxation, or culture, these can be booked directly through the app.

Putting the true problem in perspective

Users face confusion and frustration when planning dates due to indecisiveness and lack of creativity. This results in repetitive and uninspired date experiences, exacerbated by time constraints and busy schedules.

Who is the ideal user we should target?

Garv, 23 yrs, Delhi



Garv leads a **busy professional life** and is quite **active on Tinder**. He has no issue finding matches, but is constantly **running out of ideas** with each new date

Motivations: Wants to go on engaging dates that eventually lead to something serious
Challenges: Has trouble finding ideas about where to go and what to do for his dates.
Frustrations: He is frustrated when he and his partner are unable to come up with a date idea that both of them will enjoy

Solution Prioritization

SOLUTION	REACH	IMPACT	CONFIDENCE	EFFORT	RICE SCORE
Activity Matchmaker	90	3	80	100	216
Local Cuisine Explorer	85	2	80	100	136
Favorite Spots List	80	1.5	75	90	100
Meeting Point Suggestion	90	2	80	250	58
Dynamic Restaurant Finder	80	2	70	200	56
Curated Experience Package	75	1.4	70	400	18

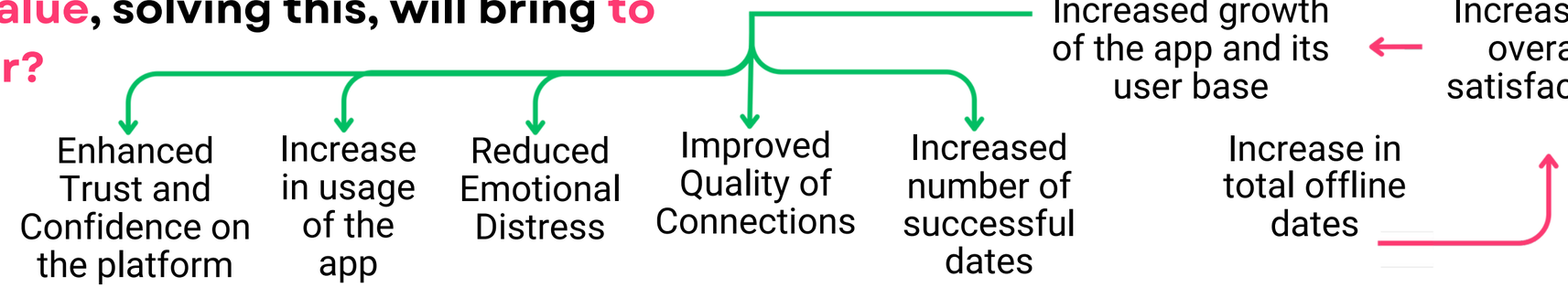
Top Solutions

1. Activity Matchmaker
2. Local Cuisine Explorer
3. Favorite Spots List

Working on the solutions, we can club the top solutions into One product based solution that tackles all 3 of our issues

We shall call this the "DATE"

What value, solving this, will bring to the user?



For the problem in perspective, what can be the potential solutions?

How to ensure an improved dating experience

Step 1: Gathering Preferences

Both users are prompted to fill in their preferences for the date. This includes:

- **Meeting Place**: Users can select or suggest locations that are convenient for both.
- **Dining Preferences:** Options for cuisine types, dietary restrictions, and preferred dining atmospheres.
- **Activity Choices:** Interests and hobbies, ranging from outdoor activities to cultural events.

Step 2: Intelligent Matching

The app uses AI to cross-reference the inputs from both users, identifying common preferences and highly rated options in their vicinity. This ensures that the suggestions are not only convenient but also aligned with what both users enjoy

Step 3: Real-Time Suggestions

Based on the matched preferences, the app generates a list of curated date ideas, including suggested meeting points, dining venues, and activities. Each suggestion comes with detailed information, such as distance, user ratings, and available booking options.

Step 4: Personalized Recommendations

Using data from previous dates and user feedback, the recommendation engine continuously improves, providing more tailored and creative suggestions over time. This personalization makes each date unique and memorable.

Intricacies of the proposed solution

Preference Collection Mechanism

Detailed User Inputs: Detailed inputs on meeting locations, dining preferences, and activities. The app must handle various data types and ensure that preferences are accurately recorded and understood.

AI-Driven Matching Engine

Algorithm Complexity: The recommendation engine uses machine learning to analyze user inputs and match preferences. This requires advanced algorithms to process and correlate large amounts of data effectively.

Why will this work?

This solution works by delivering highly personalized and relevant date suggestions through AI-driven matching and real-time data integration. Seamless booking and continuous feedback refinement ensure a user-friendly experience and ongoing improvement.

How will it look on Tinder?

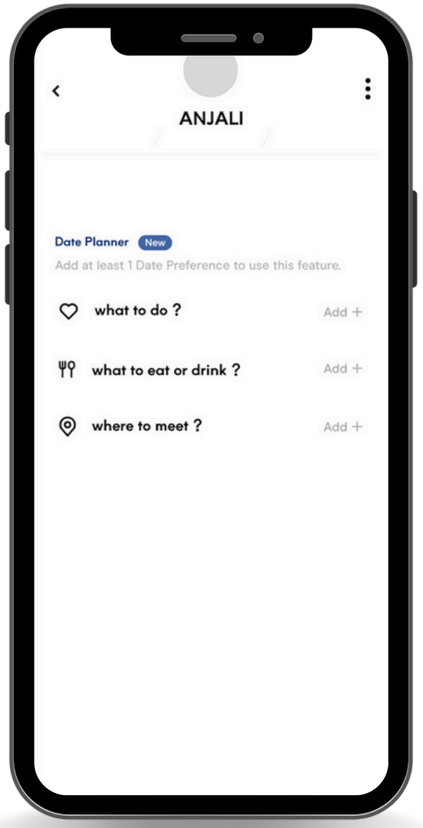


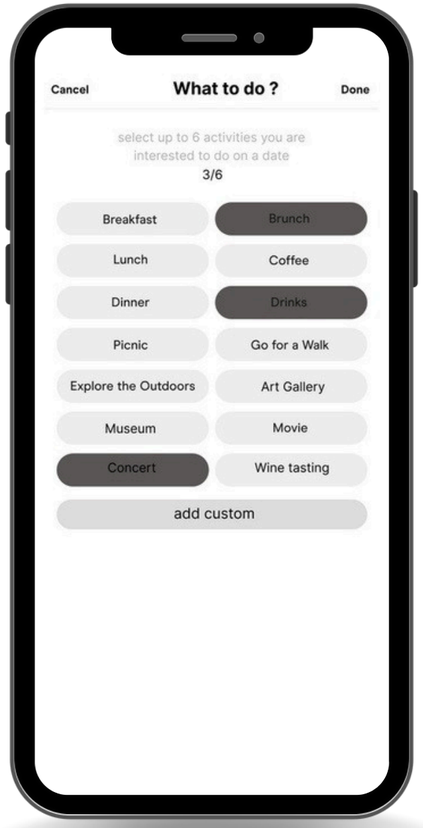
1. Enabling the DATE

A new button **DATE** becomes available which the users can click into to if they want to go to dates together

Users first fill in their **“What to do”, “Where to eat”, “Where to meet”** preferences

2. Date Preferences



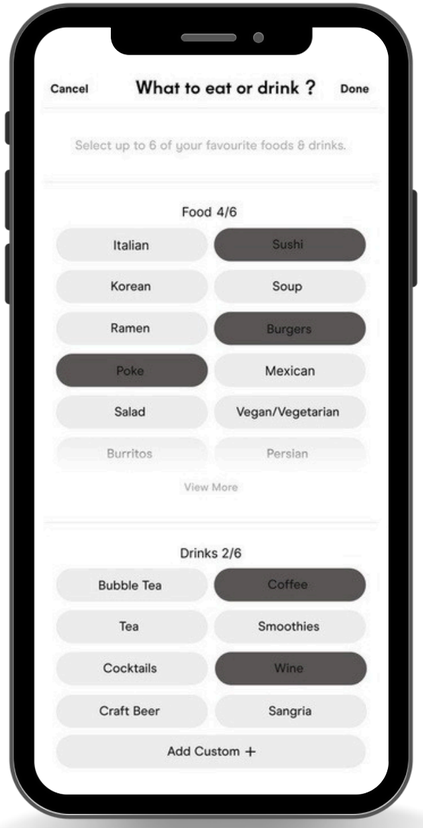


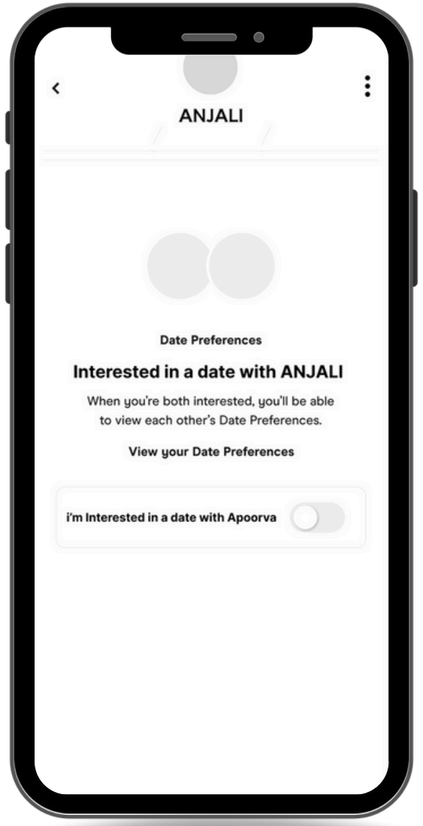
3. Filling in What to do

As shown, the users get various cards to select from according to their liking

Here, the user fills in the choice of food they like to eat, the kind of restaurants they like to go to and so on!

4. Filling in what to eat/drink

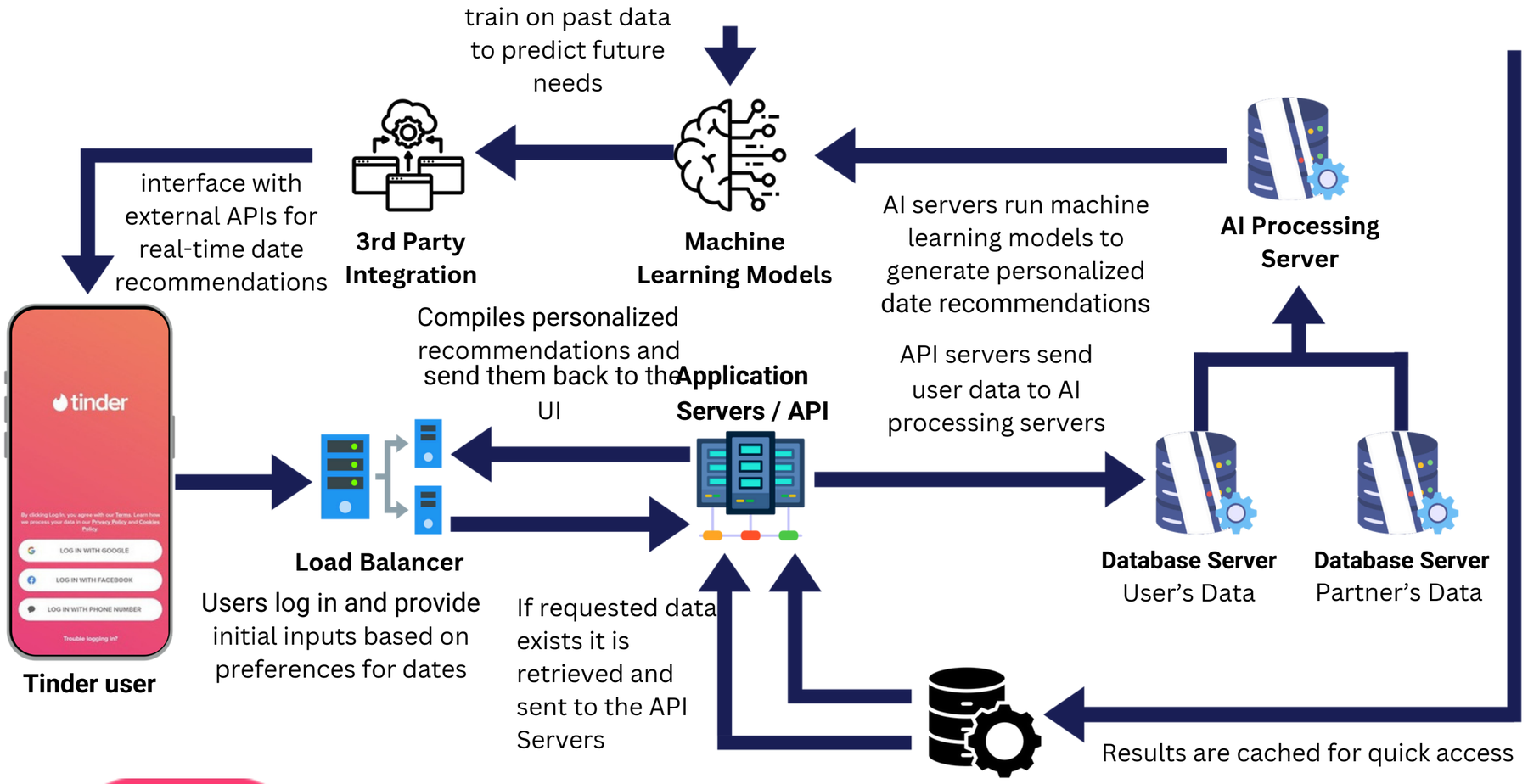




5. Enablement

Once all preferences are set for a user, they can **turn on** this feature. If both the partners turn it on, it means the users are interested in a date with each other and can proceed with the likings

A high-level system design of the solution





What can go wrong with this?

⚠ **Users may not accurately fill in their preferences, leading to suboptimal suggestions.**

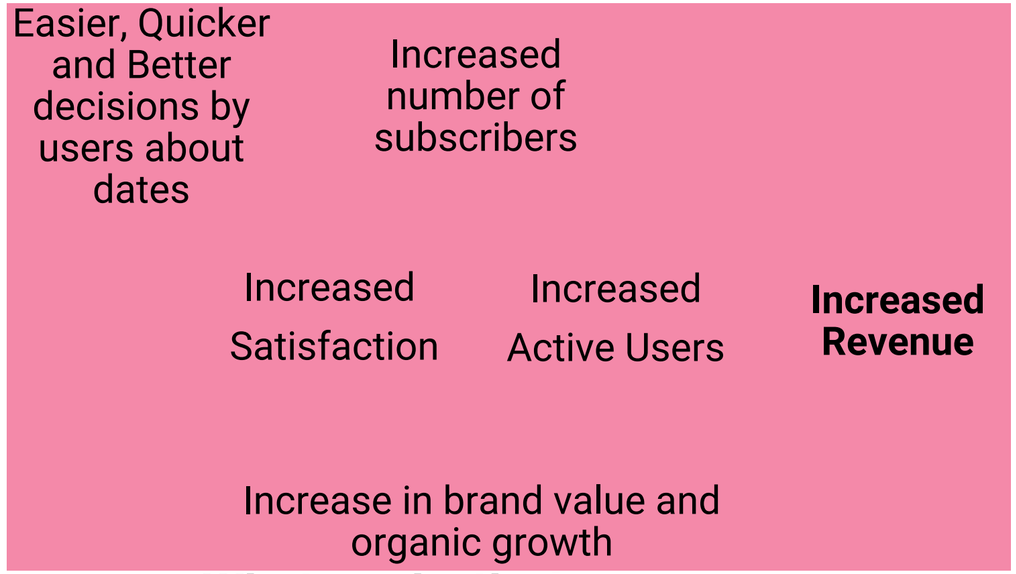
Implement smart defaults and use historical data to auto-fill preferences based on past behavior.

⚠ **Limited data could result in generic recommendations.**

Continuously refine the algorithm with user feedback and integrate third-party data sources for richer suggestions.

Mapping Success

Metric	Description
NORTH STAR Percentage of People Using the Date Feature	The proportion of users who utilize this feature. =Users using the feature/Total Users
L-1 NPS	Collect feedback after this feature to assess its accuracy an impact
L-2 CSAT Score	The average customer satisfaction score =Number of satisfied customers/sample size
New Sign-Ups:	The number of new users who register for the app.



What can be the long-term vision for this?

- **Comprehensive Dating Ecosystem:** Transform Tinder from a simple matching platform to an all-in-one date planning and experience hub.
- **User Loyalty and Retention:** Foster stronger user loyalty by addressing key pain points, leading to higher retention rates and more active users.
- **Partnership Opportunities:** Collaborate with restaurants, entertainment venues, and service providers for exclusive deals and seamless booking, generating additional revenue streams.
- **Market Leadership:** Establish Tinder as the leading dating app that not only connects people but also ensures their dates are memorable and enjoyable.